question. Even other organs of the United Nations and specialized agencies, which may at any time be so authorized by the General Assembly, may also request advisory opinions of the Court on legal questions arising within the scope of their activities.[22]

Evaluation

The ICJ has made a great contribution with its legal opinion on contentious issues. It has given its judgements in several cases which have led to a rich discourse on jurisprudence. Its landmark judgements include inter alia, *The Corfu Channel Case* (1949), *Portugal's Right of Passage Case over Enclaves against India* (1960) and the *Case between El Salvador and Honduras*. The Court, in the Nicaragua case against USA (1984–1986), did not allow the case to be removed from its list as desired by USA and issued directions to the United States to refrain from making attacks against Nicaragua. The Court also had given its advisory opinion in several cases. But the problem with the ICJ is its limited operational sphere, coupled with the power politics between the powerful states. This became particularly evident during the Cold War. Even under the present circumstances, the Soviet Union and former Communist states of Europe refuse to submit their case before the ICJ. When a mini-war ensued between Georgia and Russia in 2007, Georgia had brought a case against Russia on the ground of violation of Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (*Georgia* v. *Russia*). Russia was using all means to block the ICJ from dealing with the case.

There is also a belief that legal solutions cannot always be an acceptable one. As such, the activities of the Court are thwarted to a great extent. What can be said is that, despite several weaknesses, the ICJ has played a significant role in resolving disputes brought before it and has contributed to a steady development of international jurisprudence.